alinGherman

A Sky of Light

Chamber opera

for soprano, countertenor, clarinet in Bb (+ bass clarinet), trombone, percussion (1), piano, violin and violoncello

duration : ca. 11'

2014

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version 1 – June 2015

Commande de l'Ensemble Musiques Nouvelles (Be)
pour AUT - coOPERAtion.

Dédié à Lucifer,

Cette oeuvre a été écrite avec le soutien du Manège Mons asbl (Belgique) pour coOPERAtion, AUT.

This piece has been written with the support of *Manège Mons asbl (Belgium) for coOPERAtion, AUT.*

About the Premiere

On September 27th 2014 by Ensemble Musiques Nouvelles (BE) conducted by Jean-Paul DESSY at the Teater Katapult, Aarhus (Denmark).

Instrumentation

Soprano, Countertenor, Clarinet in Bb (+ Bass Clarinet), Trombone, Piano, Violin and Violoncello
Percussion instruments (1 player)

- 6 temple blocks
- sleigh bells
- triangle
- 3 Cymbals (ride, medium & splash, bow)
- 2 gongs (medium & large, both without specific tuning)
- Tam-tam
- Bass Drum (particularly resonant)

Program Note

This composition is based on the famous metaphysical poetry "Luceafarul" by the Romanian poet Mihai EMINESCU.

(in French) Cette œuvre est basée sur le célèbre poème métaphysique « Luceafarul » du poète roumain Mihai EMINESCU.

The excerpt used in this composition:

Translation by C.M. Popescu "Lucifer"

(...)

Lucifer set out and o'er
The sky his wings extended,
And million years flew past before
As many moments ended.

A sky of stars above his way,
A sky of stars below;
As lightning flash midst them astray
In one continuous flow.

Till round his primal chaos hurled
When from enwrapping night
The first, upflaming dawn unfurled
Its miracle of light.

Still further flew he ere the start
Of things of form devoid,
Spurred by the yearning of his heart,
Far back into the void.

Original version of 1883 in Romanian–
"Luceafarul" by Mihai Eminescu

(...)

Porni luceafărul. Creşteau
În cer a lui aripe,
Şi căi de mii de ani treceau
În tot atâtea clipe.

Un cer de stele dedesubt,
Deasupra-i cer de stele -
Părea un fulger ne'ntrerupt
Rătăcitor prin ele.

Şi din a chaosului văi,
Jur împrejur de sine,
Vedea, ca-n ziua cea dentâi,
Cum izvorau lumine;

Cum izvorând îl înconjor
Ca nişte mări, de-a-notul...
El zboară, gând purtat de dor,
Pân' piere totul, totul;

Traduction française – "Hypérion"
par Constantin Frosin

(...)

Hypérion s'en fut... Déployées,
Ses ailes assaillent la lumière.
Des milliers d'années dépassaient
A la vitesse de l'éclair.

Il survolait ciels étoilés
Surplombés par d'autres étoiles.
Tout l'air d'un éclair il avait –
Révélation sidérale.

Et comme au Jour Premier, il voit
Jaillir des gouffres du Chaos
Avant, après, autour de soi
De bien fulgurants flambeaux.

Comme des mers l'assaillent, cupides –
Il les traverse à la nage
Et le survole, l'esprit languide
Et point n'accepte leur servage

Yet where he reach'd is not the bourn
Nor yet where eye can see;
Beyond where struggling time was torn
Out of eternity.

Around him there was naught. And still,
Strange yearning there was yet,
A yearning that the space did fill,
As when the blind forget.

(...)

Take back this halo from my head,
Take back my starry lour,
And give to me, O God, instead
Of human love one hour.

(...)

Căci unde-ajunge nu-i hotar,
Nici ochi spre a cunoaşte,
Şi vremea-ncearcă în zadar
Din goluri a se naşte.

Nu e nimic şi totuşi e
O sete care-l soarbe,
E un adânc asemene
Uitării celei oarbe.

(...)

Reia-mi al nemuririi nimb
Şi focul din privire,
Şi pentru toate dă-mi în schimb
O oră de iubire...

(...)

Car sa course est illimitée,
Tout œil s'y tait, fût-il béant
Et le Temps a beau essayer
De conjurer le néant.

Tout autour il y a le vide
Comme une soif qui l'envahit :
Autant de profondeurs perfides,
Pareilles à l'aveugle oubli.

(...)

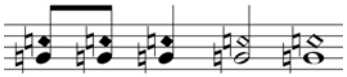
Enlève-moi ce nimbe immortel
Et toutes les foudres du regard.
Allume, en échange, la chandelle
D'une heure d'amour, même blafard.

(...)

Note

Dynamics are to be considered in an ABSOLUTE way and not related to each instrument's scale.
The accidentals last until the end of the measure. In the same measure, a new accidental cancels the preceding one.
All glissandi occupy the total duration of the note to which they are affixed.
When vibrato markings are not specified, players can use their usual vibrato.
l.v. = let vibrate (do not dampen) **s.v.** = senza vibrato **p.v.** = poco vibrato **m.v.** = molto vibrato **s.p.** = sul ponticello **s.t.** = sul tasto **sub.** = subito

= fermata's value = mute completely *mp* ← – → *f* = indeterminate fluctuation between these limits

Notation of Harmonics: 

The first pages of the score are

NOT INCLUDED in this free PREVIEW.

Contact Alin GHERMAN to obtain the full SCORE.

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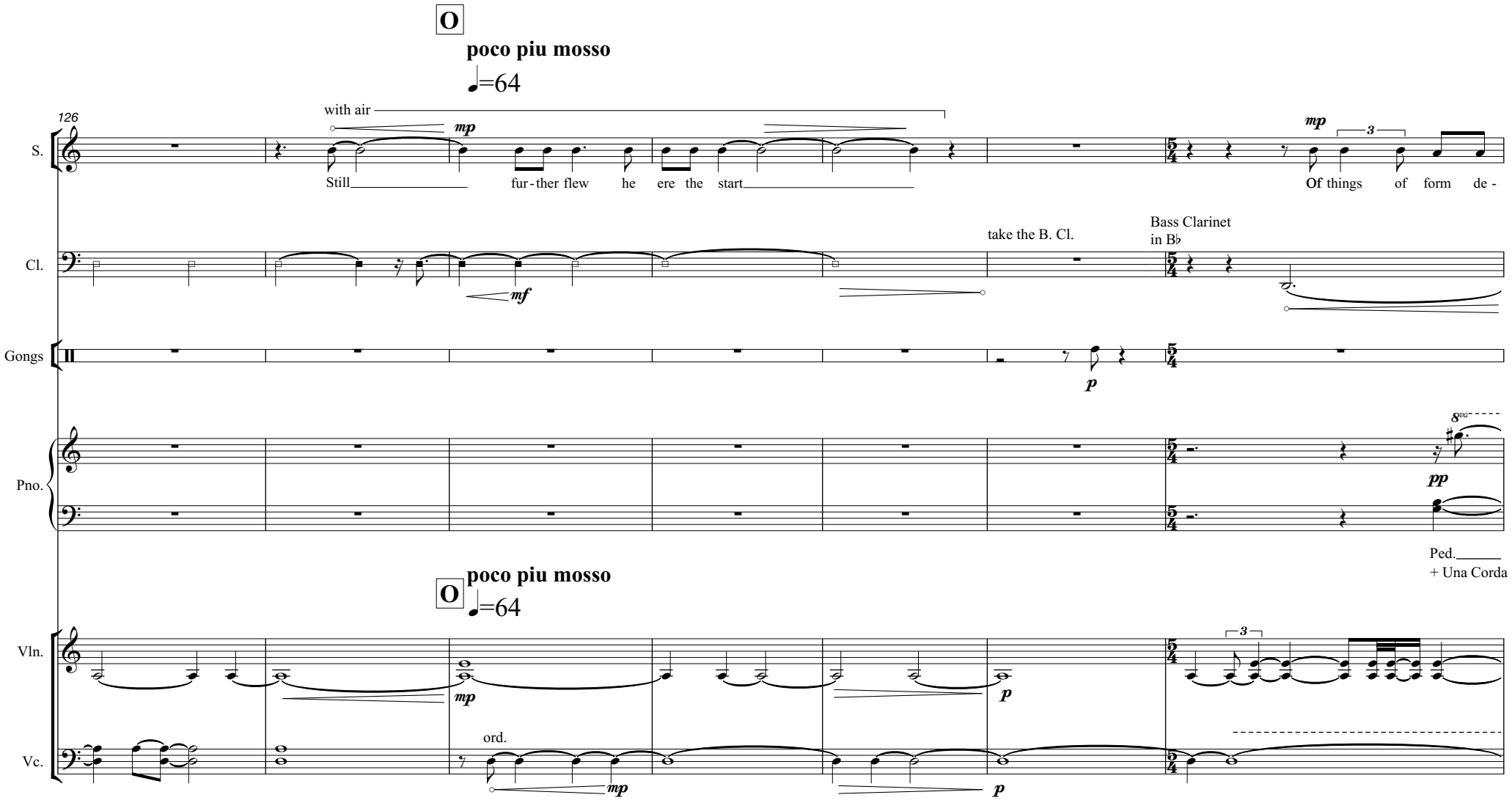
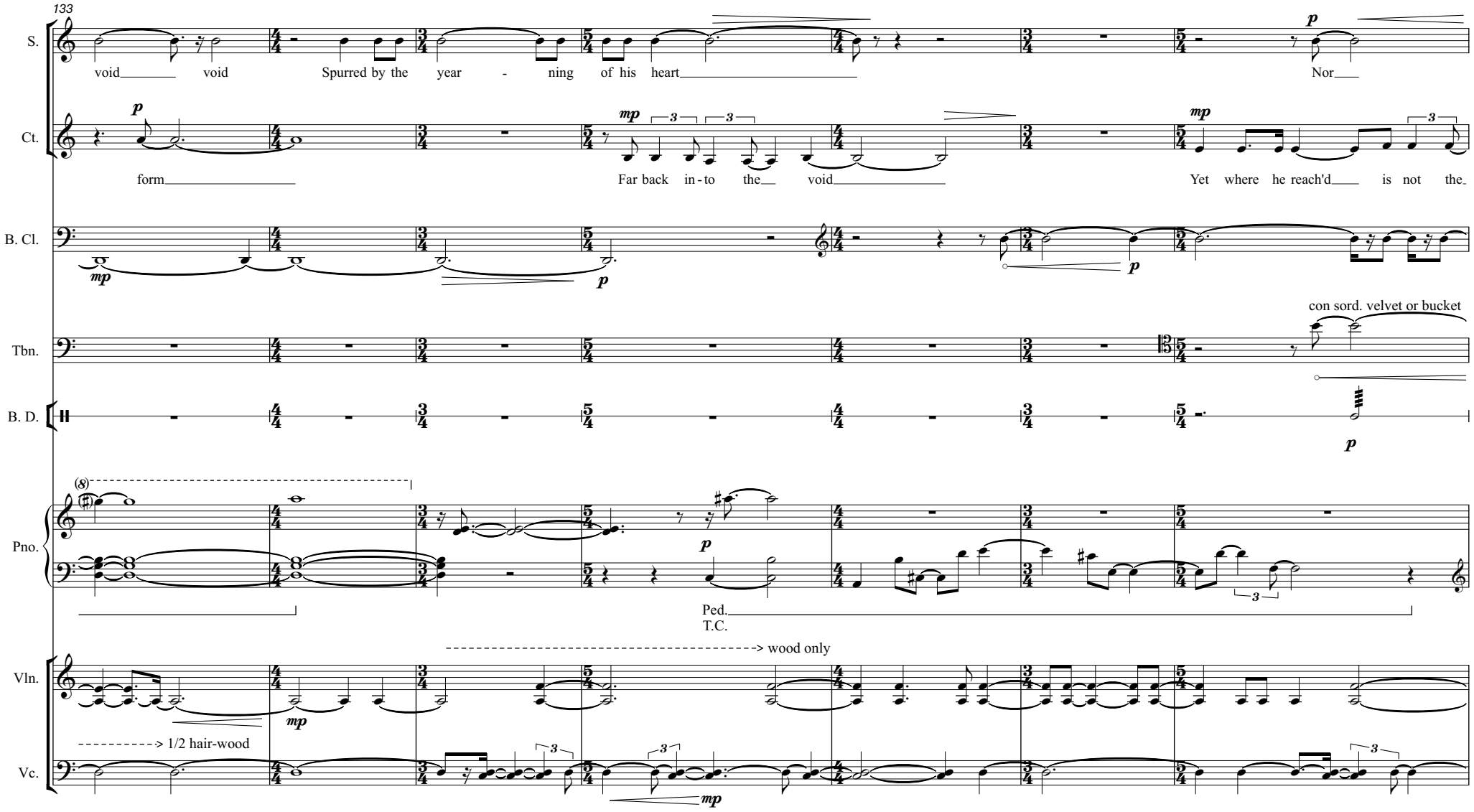
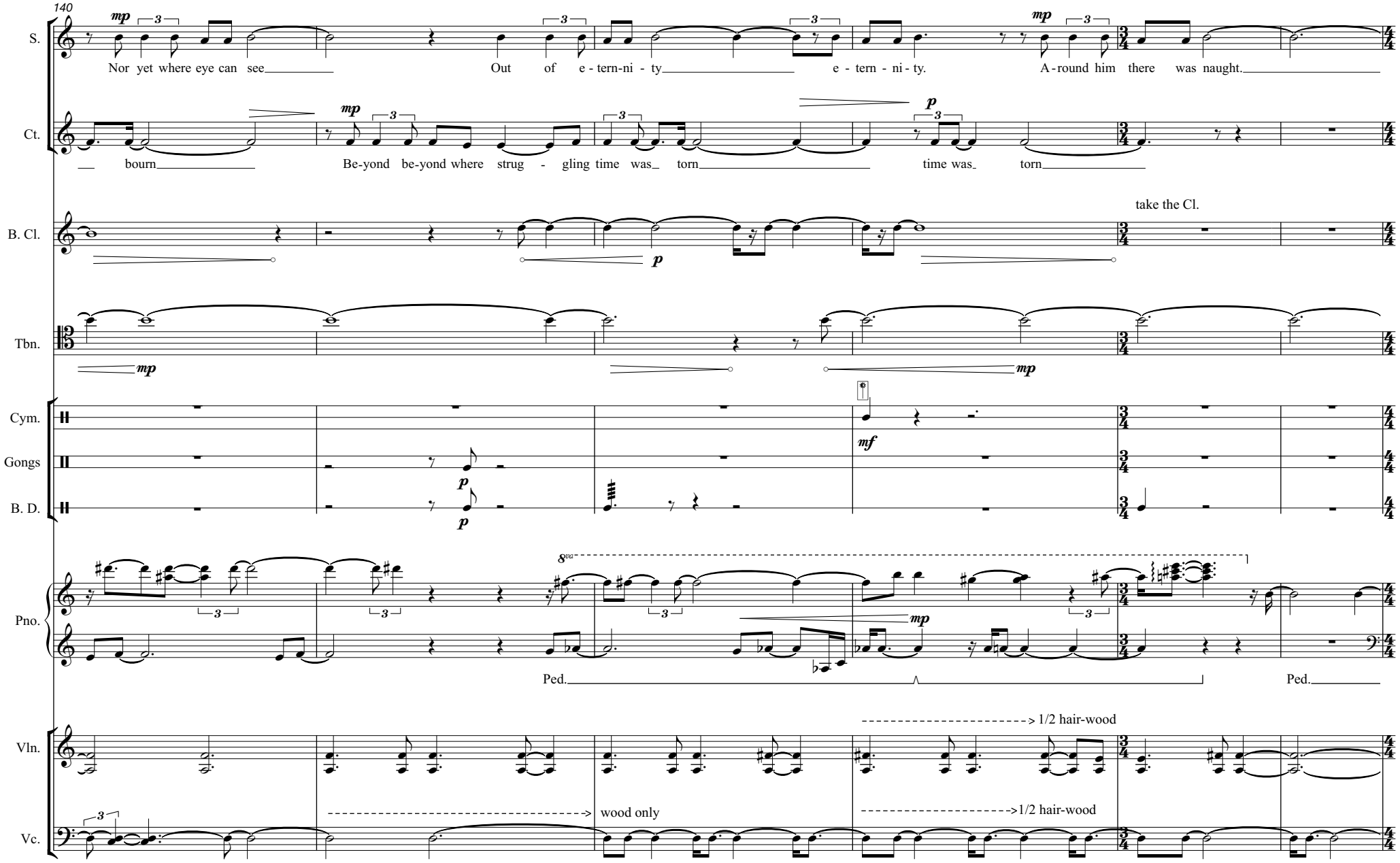
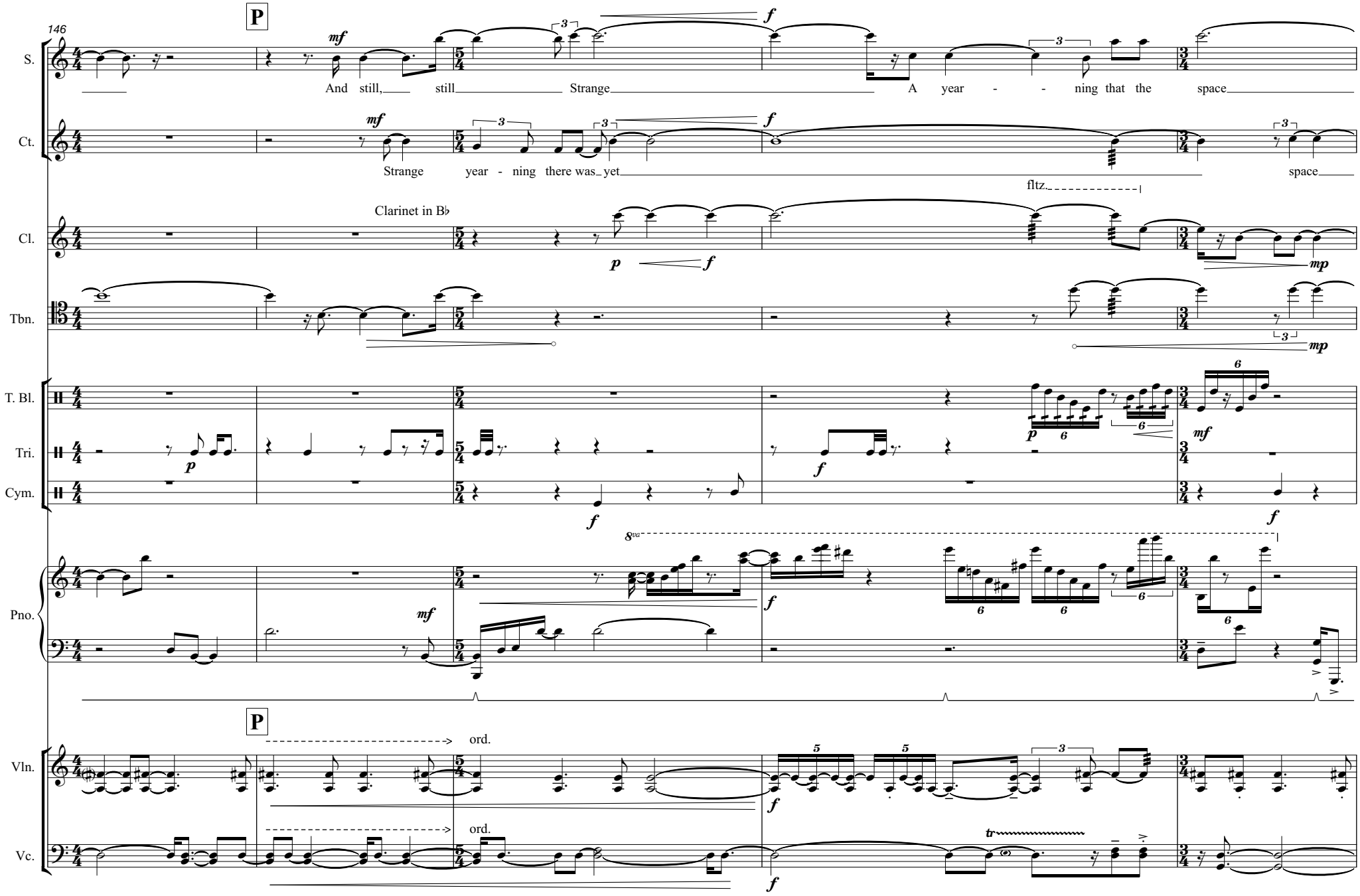
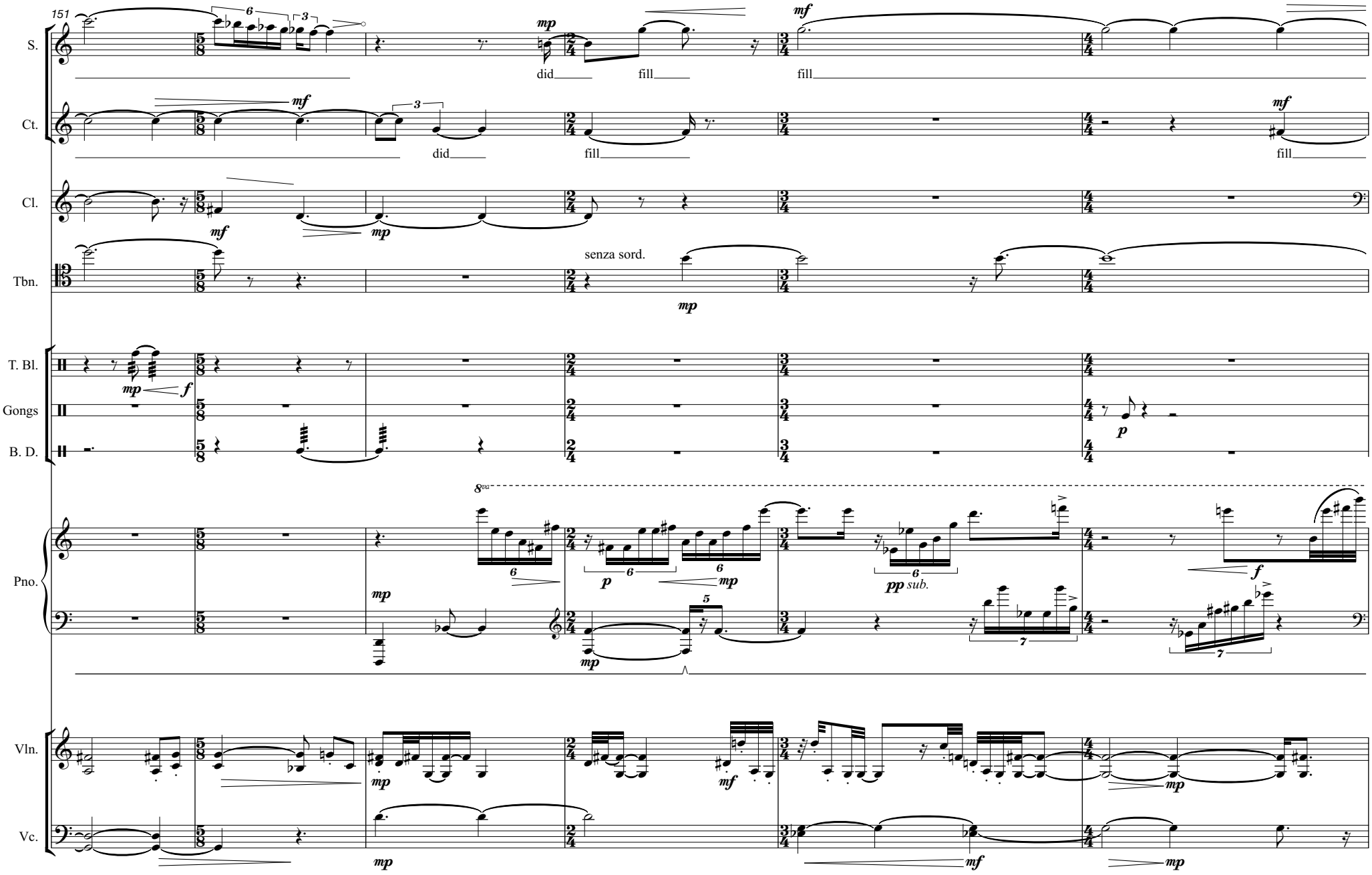
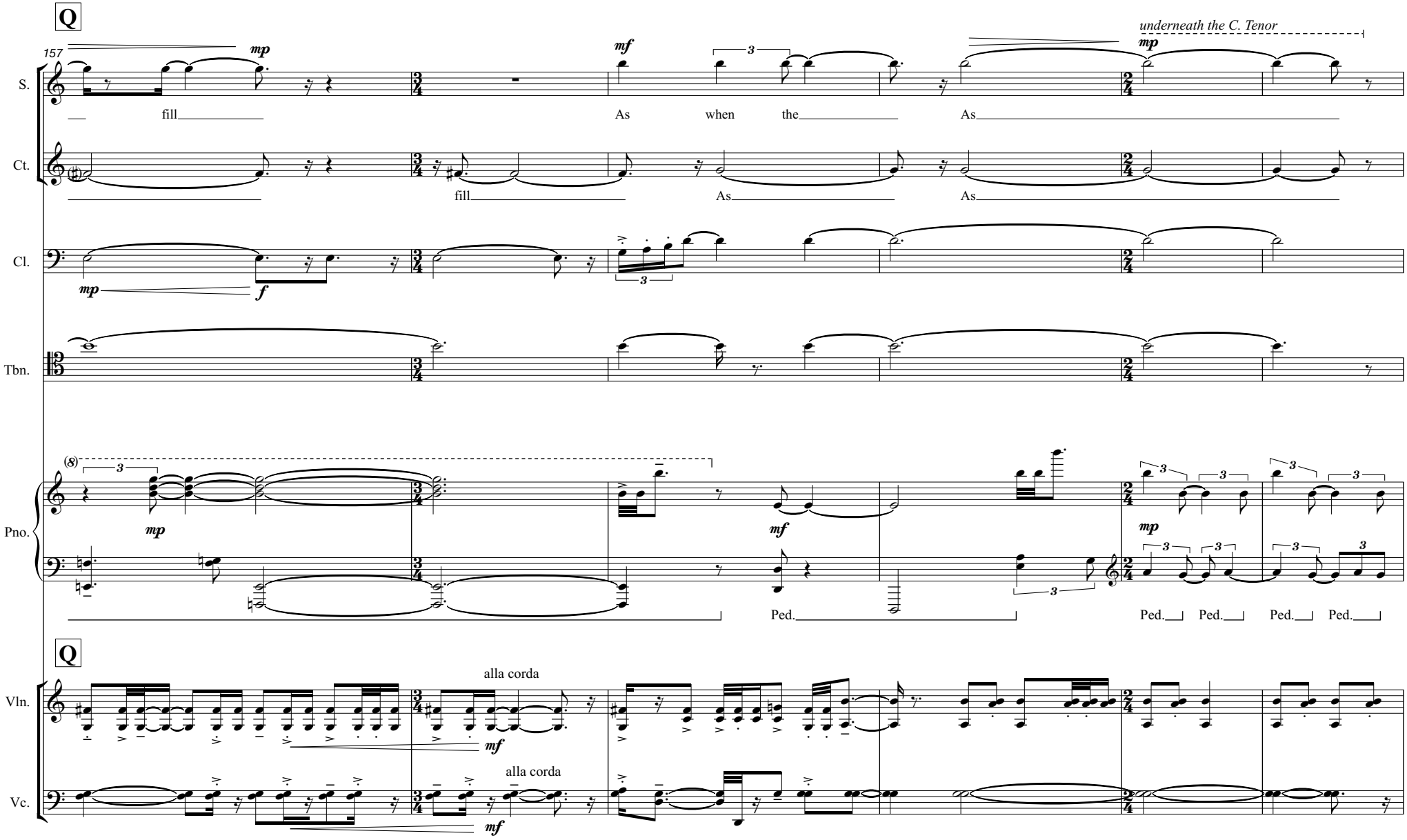

O
poco piu mosso
♩=64
126
with air
S.
Still fur-ther flew he ere the start
Of things of form de-
Cl.
take the B. Cl.
Bass Clarinet in B♭
Gongs
Pno.
Ped.
+ Una Corda
O
poco piu mosso
♩=64
Vln.
Vc.
ord.

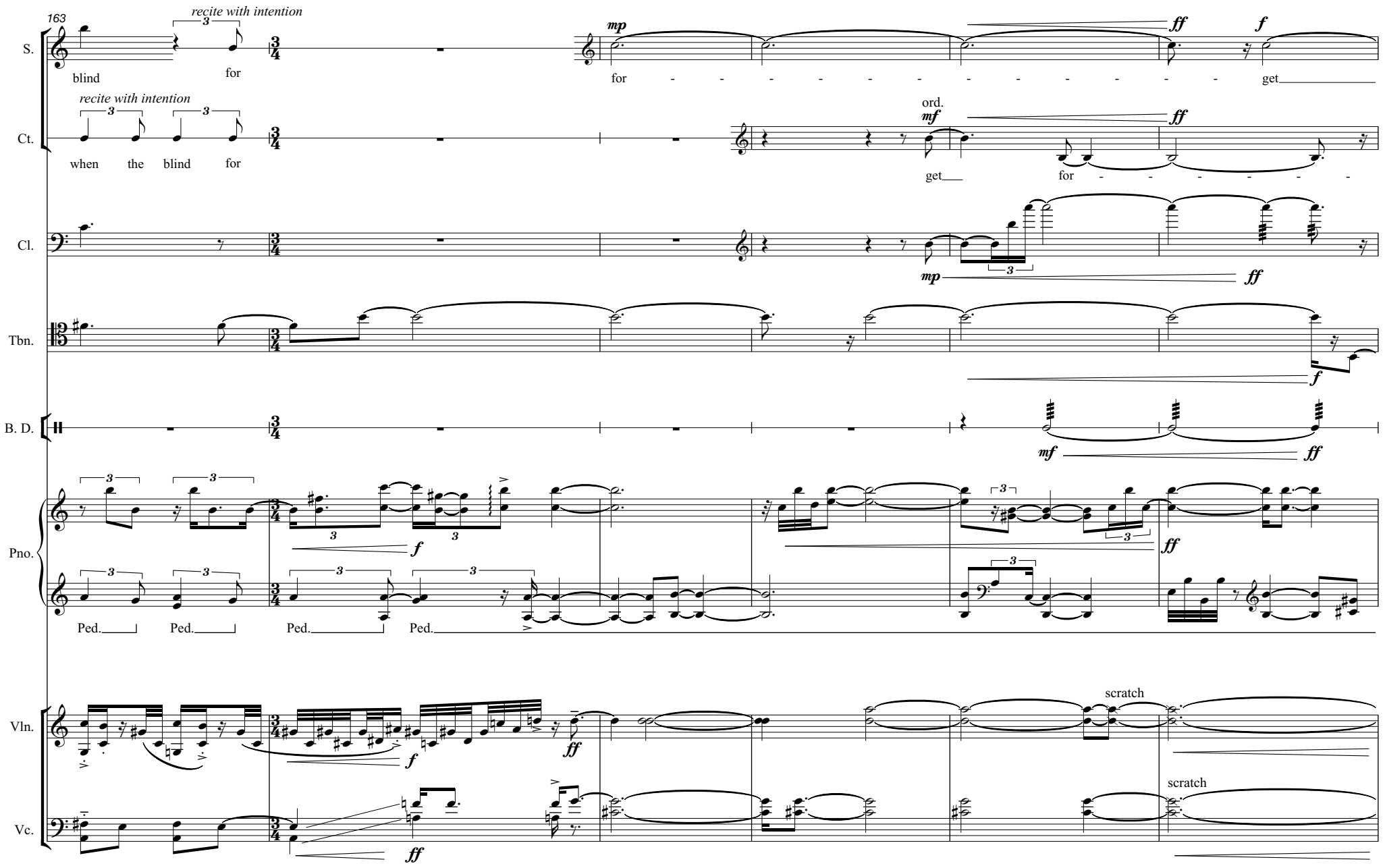

133
S.
void void Spurred by the year - ning of his heart
Nor
Ct.
form
Far back in - to the void
Yet where he reach'd is not the
B. Cl.
Tbn.
con sord. velvet or bucket
B. D.
Pno.
Ped.
T.C.
Vln.
wood only
1/2 hair-wood
Vc.


140
S.
Nor yet where eye can see
Out of e - tern-ni - ty
e - tern - ni - ty.
A - round him there was naught.
Ct.
bourn
Be-yond be-yond where strug - gling time was torn
time was torn
B. Cl.
take the Cl.
Tbn.
Cym.
Gongs
B. D.
Pno.
Ped.
Ped.
Vln.
1/2 hair-wood
Vc.
wood only
1/2 hair-wood


146
P
S.
And still, still Strange A year - - ning that the space
Ct.
Strange year - ning there was yet space
fltz.
Clarinet in B♭
Cl.
Tbn.
T. Bl.
Tri.
Cym.
Pno.
P
ord.
Vln.
Vc.


151
S.
did
fill
fill
Ct.
did
fill
fill
Cl.
senza sord.
Tbn.
T. Bl.
Gongs
B. D.
Pno.
pp sub.
Vln.
Vc.


Q
157
S.
fill
As when the
As
underneath the C. Tenor
Ct.
fill
As
As
Cl.
Tbn.
Pno.
Ped.
Ped.
Ped.
Ped.
Ped.
Q
Vln.
alla corda
Vc.
alla corda


163
recite with intention
S.
blind
for
mp
for - - - - - - - - - - - - get
ff
f
recite with intention
Ct.
when the blind for
ord.
mf
get
for - - - - - -
ff
Cl.
mp
ff
Tbn.
f
B. D.
mf
ff
Pno.
f
ff
Ped.
Ped.
Ped.
Ped.
Vln.
f
ff
scratch
Vc.
ff
scratch

version 1

169

S. Solo

Ct.

Cl.

Tbn.

Cym.

Gongs

B. D.

Pno.

Vln.

Vc.

R

cut

recite with passion

Take back this halo from my head, Take back my starry lour, And give to me, O God, instead Of human love one hour.

- get

get

add the flt. as soon as it's stable

ff

f

mf

mp

fff

fff poss.

duration : ca. 11 min. 40 sec.